The Great Pumpkin



DM GAMES

GUILD

Welcome to “The Pumpkin King”, a free Halloween encounter from DM Games! Unlike our full modules, this is a one shot encounter that can be dropped into an existing campaign or the springboard to start one.

This encounter takes place in the dreaded domain of Ravenloft, however it can be dropped into any one of D&D’s many settings or one of your own invention. This adventure is for 4 PCs level 1 - 2

What is needed to Play?

All you NEED for this adventure is this book and a copy of the Dungeons & Dragons basic rules which are able to be downloaded for free from playdnd.com. and a set of gaming dice. I would also Highly recommend the SRD available from the same sight as it has a COMPLETE listing of all D&D Rules.

In addition, I would also recommend some miniatures and an erasable battle mat, but those are completely optional. Our maps

Encounter Synopsis

The small farming village of Krahedorf, if you can call their meager corn crops “farms”, has had a rash of children go missing leading up to all hallows eve. Even for Barovia this is not a common problem. Speaking to the villagers its become apparent that their is something sinister in the area.

The creature taking the children has come to be known as “The Great Pumpkin”. He takes many forms but favors that of a scarecrow as he can easily replace the many other regular rag doll manequins,

The Punkin’, as he is sometimes know as, will send envoys of his “children” into town during the revels leading up to all hallows eve and spread rumors of sweets and gifts in the corn field to lure his unsuspecting victims to him. Once there, the children go missing and become his minions for eternity, consuming the souls required for him to return yet another year and feast.

The Great Pumpkin has no motivation other than to feed and revel in the souls of the stolen children for yet another year. Such is the perversion of a demon

The Adventure Begins

Read the following boxed text to the players to start the Adventure:

> When you entered Krahedorf Village, you were ready to take a rest from your travels. It had been a hard road, and stops between your journey’s departure point and destination have been few and far between, but such is the life of a new adventurer.
>
> While enjoying your meal, well at least having…”enjoying” is a strong word in this case, you and your party are approached by several haggard and sorrow weary villagers. They tell you a tale of how their children have got missing and they suspect “The Great Pumpkin” or “The Punkin’” as one particularly dim witted villager calls him, has lured the children to the cornfields with promises of treats and gifts.

The Cornfield

Feeling particularly heroic, you promise the worried villagers that you will go to the cornfield and will not return without their children

The Players arrive at the cornfield and on your typical cold “dark and stormy nights” so familiar in every halloween and horror stories. And while this is designed as a “tongue in cheek” halloween adventure, it should be treated some what seriously. It IS a horror story after all, and as the players will soon discover, the “Minions” they are fighting are what is left of the children after “The Punkin’” gets a hold of them.

Read the text of the players:

As you approach the cornfield an ominous feeling settles over you. The wind picks up and you are almost instantly chilled to the bone. Between the icy gale and the mist that begins to saturate your clothes, you swear you can almost feel your body temperature drop.

Looking around, you find a path that leads deeper into the cornfield and realize it is in fact a corn maze. When you venture forth, blue-white lightening splits the sky as a loud “CRACK” resonates through the countryside. You begin to think you may be in over your head.

Random Encounters

1 - 2 4x Swarm of Ravens

3 - 4 4x Swarm of Rats

5 - 6 4x Swarm of Insects

The players wander through the corn maze a bit and once they have faced off 6 “random: encounters, one EVERY OTHER turn, the secret entrance reveals itself as marked on the map below.

Once the players find the entrance, the players will face of the Pumpkin King and his Pump-kids, little demon spawn that are the reincarnated souls of his victims. They can be set anywhere on the map in the appropriate area.

The Statistics for the Swarms can be found in the Monster Manual or the SRD located at www.playdnd.com or at dndbeyond.com.

Statistics for the Great Pumpkin and the Pump-kids are listed on the next page. Insect, Raven and Rat Swarms are found in the Monster Manual or 5e SRD



The Great Pumpkin

The Great Pumpkin is essentially a Scarecrow but where other constructs of this type are typically infused with the spirit of some malevolent person, the pumpkin is infused with that of demon! He has taken many shapes throughout his long history, his two favorite are either that of a Scarecrow or that of a tangle mass of vines and pumpkins that has a humanoid shape (www.reapermini.com has a FANTASTIC model of this). Needless to say, he loves to claim the souls of children and making little hellspawn of undead “Pumpkids”. Small child like creatures with the head of a Jack-O-Lantern. It is a gruesome practice but one that given the great pumpkin his powers over the centuries and allowed him to sustain his life force for centuries



The Great Pumpkin

Demonic Construct, Chaotic Evil

Armor Class 13
Hit Points 88 (12d12 +12)
Speed 30 ft

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
11 (+0)	13 (+1)	11(+0)	14 (+2).	13 (+1)	13 (+1)

Saving Throws: Dex +1, Cha +1
Damage Vulnerabilities: Fire
Damage Resistances: bludgeoning, piercing and slashing from non magical attacks
Damage Immunities: poison
Condition Immunities: Charmed, exhaustion, frightened, paralyzed, poisoned, unconscious
Senses: darkvision 60 ft, passive Perception 10
Languages: Understands common and abyssal but cant speak
Challenge: 2 (450 XP)
False Appearance: While the Great Pumpkin is motionless it is indistinguishable from an actual scarecrow

ACTIONS

Multi Attack: The Scarecrow makes 2 claw attacks

Claws: Melee Weapon Attack: +5 to hit, reach 5 ft, one creature. 7 (2d4+3) If the target is a creature it must succeed on a DC 13 Wisdom saving throw or be frightened until the end of the Great Pumpkin’s next turn.

Terrifying Glare: The Great Pumpkin targets one creature it can see within 30 feet of it. If the target can see the Great Pumpkin, the target must succeed on a DC 13 Wisdom saving throw or be magically frightened until the end of the Great Pumpkin's next turn. The Frightened market is paralyzed.

Raise Pumpkids: Every other turn the great pumpkin can raise a pumpkid on a Charisma roll of 15 up to a maximum of 6.

Pumpkids

Pumpkids

Small Demonic Undead

Armor Class 13
Hit Points 13 (2d8+4)
Speed 30 ft

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	14(+2)	11(+0)	6 (-2)	8 (-1)	5 (-3)

Damage Vulnerabilities: Bludgeoning
Damage Resistances: piercing and slashing from non magical attacks
Damage Immunities: poison
Condition Immunities: exhaustion, frightened, poisoned
Senses: darkvision 60 ft, passive perception 0
Languages: Understands common but cant speak
Challenge: 1/4 (50 XP)

ACTIONS

Claws: Melee Weapon Attack: +5 to hit, reach 5 ft, one creature. 3 (1d4+1)

Pitiful Gaze: So heartbreaking is the fate of the children that on a Wisdom DC 15 check they cast a pitiful gaze on one creature. That creature is so overcome with sorrow that it is paralyzed for one turn

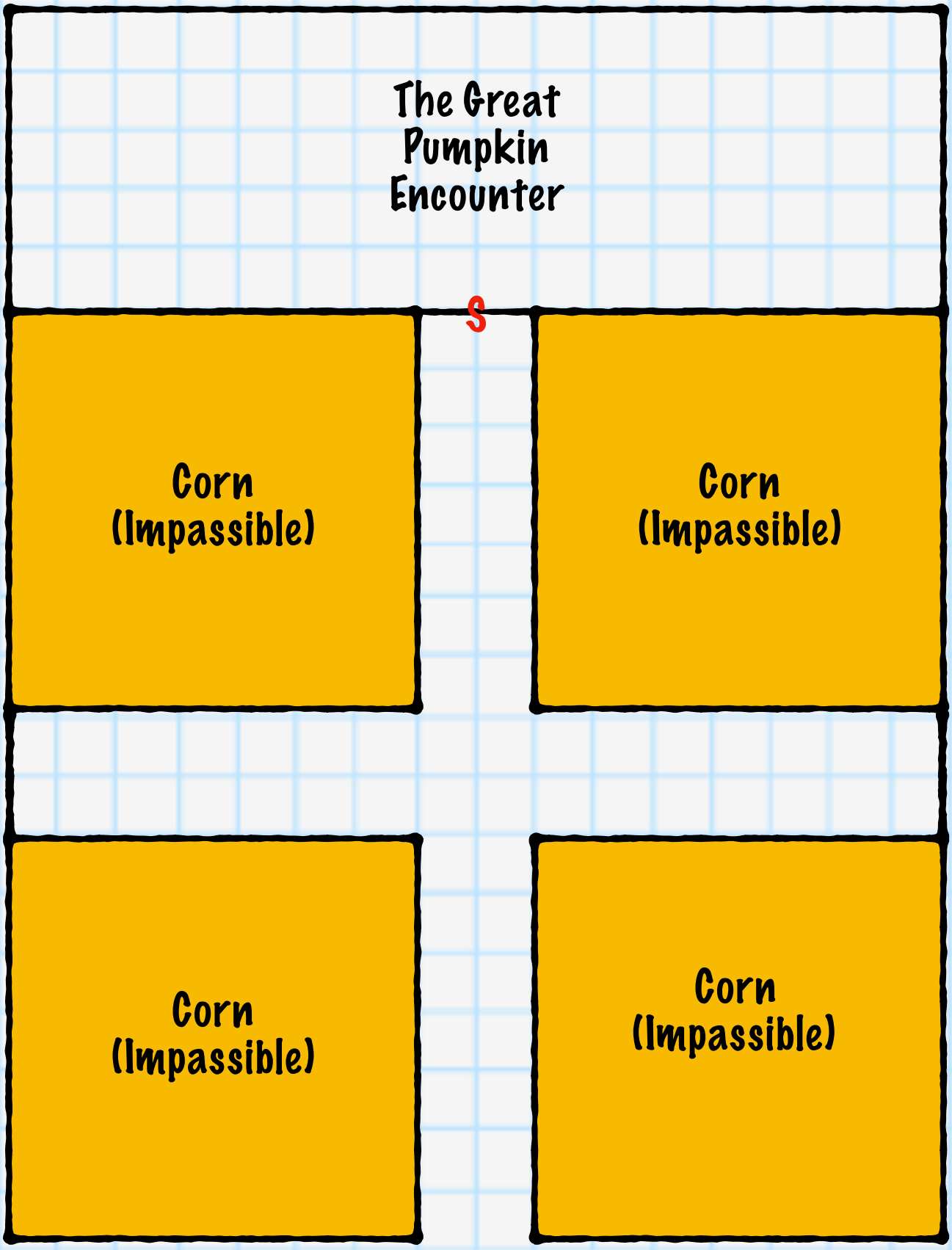
The Pumpkids are a very sad creation of the children the Great Pumpkin has slain. While he feeds on their spirits, the tortured souls of his tiny victims are placed in what is left of their desiccated bodies. As a reflection of their master, the Pumpkids heads twist and contort until they resemble the leering faces of Jack O' Lanterns.

These tormented little souls are vicious and attack the living on site, unless told otherwise by their twisted master.

Occasionally, he uses these creations on All Hallows Eve to lure even more youthful victims to their eternal damnation.

Such is the evil of the "Great" Pumpkin.




The Great Pumpkin Encounter
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Sometimes, miniatures can be so AWESOME that they inspire a module, such as this one. Check out Reaper Miniatures for all the minis used in the creation of this adventure and thanks for playing!



03377: Rotpatch, Pumpkin Golem



03479: Murder of Crows



77130: Vermin: Beetle Swarm



03677: Pumpkin Minions



03394: Rat Swarm